

PRESS RELEASE

Georgian Book Day in Berlin Brings Georgian Literature and Culture to the German Capital

Nino Haratischwili, Lasha Bakradze, Thomas Franke and Ana Chubinidze are among the guests on 11 October. Around 800 books will be brought from Georgia to Berlin for a day of literature, debate, readings and encounters.

On Sunday, 11 October, the **Georgian Book Day in Berlin** will bring contemporary Georgian literature, history and cultural debate. More than 300 Georgian- and German-language titles will be presented, with around 800 books brought to Berlin especially for the event. Several Georgian publishers will attend in person, while many of the books on display are otherwise difficult to obtain in Germany.

The event takes place at a critical moment for Georgia. Political turmoil, continuing protests and growing pressure on independent media, civil society and cultural actors have shaped international perceptions of the country. The Georgian Book Day does not seek to separate culture from this reality. Rather, it places the political present alongside a broader view of Georgia as a country with a distinctive, diverse and vibrant literary and cultural life.

Among the guests is acclaimed novelist and playwright **Nino Haratischwili**, one of the most prominent Georgian voices in German-language literature and recipient of numerous literary honours, including the City of Fulda's 2026 Winfried Prize. Together with literary and cultural scholar Zaal Andronikashvili, she will discuss what drives contemporary Georgian writers.

Literature is joined by conversations about history and the political present. Historian and former director of Georgia's National Literature Museum **Lasha Bakradze** will moderate a discussion on Georgia's Soviet legacy, cultures of remembrance and historical responsibility, including the German concept of *Vergangenheitsbewältigung* – coming to terms with the past – as a point of comparison.

A further panel will address protest, freedom and Georgia's European future. Among its participants is journalist and author **Thomas Franke**, co-author with Gesine Dornblüth of *Kampf um die Freiheit: Georgien und der lange Arm des Kreml*, published by Herder in 2025. The discussion will consider the current political crisis, civic resistance and the situation facing journalists and cultural figures in Georgia.

The programme also brings Georgian literature to younger audiences. Internationally acclaimed Georgian filmmaker and illustrator **Ana Chubinidze**, whose animated films have been selected by more than 250 festivals and received around 50 awards, will lead an animation workshop for children aged eight and above. Readings in Georgian and German, short book presentations and encounters with publishers complement the programme.

The literary programme concludes with **Mario Pschera** of Dağyeli Verlag and musician Aleksandre Kharanauli presenting poetry by **Besik Kharanauli** and **Zviad Ratiani** in Georgian and German. Entitled *Georgia Belongs to You, Only to You*, the reading will be accompanied by musical improvisation.

The Georgian Book Day is organised by **GZA – Georgian Centre Abroad e. V.**, a non-profit association founded in Berlin in 2023 by Georgians living in Germany. The event is organised entirely voluntarily and without institutional funding. Through the initiative, GZA aims to give Georgian books, authors and cultural voices greater visibility in Germany while creating a space for exchange between Georgian and German cultural communities.

The event concludes on 12 October with **Georgian Book Day Presents: LIVE**. Reso Kiknadze, Guram Machavariani and Anuka Kontridze will perform free improvisation accompanied by live drawing from Berlin-based comic artist **Mawil**. Aleksandre Kharanauli opens the evening with contemporary interpretations of Georgian folk music.



EVENT INFORMATION

Georgian Book Day in Berlin

Sunday, 11 October 2026

Doors: 12:00

Programme: 13:00–18:00

Hotel Continental – Art Space in Exile

Elsenstraße 87

12435 Berlin

Admission free

Follow-up event:

Georgian Book Day Presents: LIVE

Monday, 12 October 2026

Hotel Continental – Art Space in Exile

ABOUT GZA

GZA – Georgian Centre Abroad e. V. is a non-profit association founded in Berlin in 2023 by Georgians living in Germany. It creates platforms for raising awareness about the political environment in Georgia, culture, literature and public discourse and promotes cultural exchange between Georgia and Germany.

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PRESS MATERIALS & INTERVIEWS

Press photographs and further information are available upon request. Interview requests with participating authors, artists and organisers are welcome.

The full **programme** is available [here](#)